

SENATE RESOLUTION 350

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the 100th anniversary of the
Nashville Alumni Chapter of Kappa Alpha Psi
Fraternity, Inc.

WHEREAS, it is our pleasure to recognize the Nashville Alumni Chapter of Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., on the 100th anniversary of its founding; and

WHEREAS, Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., was founded on January 5, 1911, and has maintained a historic commitment to achievement in every field of human endeavor; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Alumni Chapter of Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., was duly chartered on April 24, 1926, making it one of the fraternity's earliest alumni chapters; and

WHEREAS, the establishment of the Nashville Alumni Chapter was initiated under the leadership of J. Ernest Wilkins, then Grand Keeper of Records and Exchequer, and has since remained an enduring presence in the Middle Tennessee region; and

WHEREAS, for 100 years, the Nashville Alumni Chapter (NAC) of Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., has stood as a pillar of brotherhood, leadership, and service to the Nashville community and will commemorate this historic occasion with a Centennial Celebration held on April 23-26, 2026; and

WHEREAS, the Centennial Celebration honors the visionary brothers who set the foundation on which members of the NAC stand today and celebrates the enduring legacy that continues to shape the next generation; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Alumni Chapter, in alignment with the Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, is wholly devoted to fostering excellence within its members and helping to develop global leaders in various disciplines; and

WHEREAS, the NAC has distinguished itself as a public service organization devoted to philanthropic endeavors. NAC members played significant roles in the lunch counter sit-in

demonstrations in downtown Nashville in 1960 and established seasonal community events in 1983; the Nashville Guide Right Foundation, the charitable arm of the chapter, was later organized in 1996; and

WHEREAS, the governance and stewardship of the chapter have been carried forward through the faithful service of its elected Polemarchs: Dr. Henry H. Walker, 1st Polemarch (1926–1936); Merl R. (Rawls) Eppse, 2nd Polemarch (1936–1937); Swazzie L. Hall, 3rd Polemarch (1937–1940); William J. Gupton, Sr., 4th Polemarch (1940–1950); William F. Butler, 5th Polemarch (1950–1951); Swazzie L. Hall, 6th Polemarch (1951–1953); Cass F. L. Teague, Sr., 7th Polemarch (1953–1955); Clyde Leathers, 8th Polemarch (1955–1956); Samuel P. Massie, 9th Polemarch (1956–1959); O. W. Crump, 10th Polemarch (1959–1961); William J. Gupton, Sr., 11th Polemarch (1961–1965); A. A. Birch, 12th Polemarch (1965–1967); Shannon D. Little, 13th Polemarch (1967–1973); Sterlin N. Adams, 14th Polemarch (1973–1976); Joe E. Seibert, 15th Polemarch (1976–1979); Leonard H. Morton, Sr., 16th Polemarch (1979–1982); James A. Ellzy, 17th Polemarch (1982–1993); Henry A. Atwater II, 18th Polemarch (1993–1995); Johnnie Carey, 19th Polemarch (1995–1996); William T. Haston, 20th Polemarch (1996–1999); Don C. McNeil, Sr., 21st Polemarch (1999–2002); Henry James Murrell, 22nd Polemarch (2002–2005); James E. Dukes, Sr., 23rd Polemarch (2005–2008); Gregory A. Clark, 24th Polemarch (2008–2011); Anthony T. Owens, 25th Polemarch (2011–2014); Gregory A. Clark, 26th Polemarch (2014–2017); John H. Ford, 27th Polemarch (2017–2020); Alger M. Studstill, 28th Polemarch (2020–2023); and Tillman W. Payne III, 29th Polemarch (2023–present); and

WHEREAS, in addition to the exceptional work and service of NAC's Polemarchs, notable members include Brother James "JT" Smith, who faithfully chaired the chapter's Thanksgiving giveaway for more than two decades, and Brother Professor Neal McAlpine, who, for more than forty years, served as a professor of horticulture at Tennessee State University

and was widely respected for his research, among other members who worked tirelessly to advance the organization's mission; and

WHEREAS, the twenty-ninth administration of NAC includes Polemarch Tillman Payne; MOL Vice Polemarch Anthony Smith; Keeper of Records Ryan Mabry; Keeper of Exchequer Michael Majors; Reporter Jeffery Thomas; Historian Larry Morris; Chaplain Lee Allen; Strategus Andrew Butler; and Lieutenant Strategus Derrick Moore; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Alumni Chapter was duly named Chapter of the Year in 2008, 2009, 2011, 2012, and 2014, most befitting honors that recognize its members' devotion to service, leadership, and philanthropy; and

WHEREAS, since its chartering, the Nashville Alumni Chapter has provided 100 years of continuous service through leadership development, educational support, youth mentorship, civic engagement, and community uplift; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Alumni Chapter has consistently advanced the objectives of Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., while maintaining a legacy of leadership, service, and excellence, and it is fitting that the members of this legislative body honor its members on the chapter's centennial celebration; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we recognize and congratulate the Nashville Alumni Chapter of Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc., on the occasion of its 100th anniversary.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.